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Chapter 2

Advanced Shipping Overview



Introduction

Advanced Shipping provides the following functions, which are described more fully later:

- Master file maintenance.
- Build and maintain shipping consignments.
- Confirm despatches and consignments.
- Consignment processing.
- Consignment stocks and self billing.
- Fastpath shipping and confirmation.
- Automatic pack and pallet creation, with override capability.
- Sourcing from multiple stockrooms.
- Stock reservation.
- Special rules for shipping receipt advice notification (RAN) requirements.
- Load simulation facility.
- Multiple invoice consolidation levels.
- ASNs and ANSIX12 856 ASNs.

Advanced Shipping was designed as a separate module as it is integrated into other modules in addition to Advanced Customer Scheduling.

This module is an advanced business module and this product guide assumes that you are familiar with the following:

- A knowledge of how the server operates.
- A knowledge of how the JBA modules work.
- An understanding of Customer Scheduling in a repetitive manufacturing environment.
- Knowledge of how goods are collated and despatched.

Master File Maintenance

The Advanced Shipping module aims to cater for the special requirements of repetitive supply chain industries, for example in the automotive or white goods sectors.

The module allows you to manage and monitor complex supply contracts. Advanced Shipping provides maintenance functions which are explained in more detail later in this section:

- Company
- Customer
- Contract

These are repetitive functions which filter the default values down from company to customer, and from customer to contract level. This minimises the amount of keying involved in setting up a new contract whilst allowing the flexibility of overrides at the lower levels.

Advanced Customer Scheduling calls Advanced Shipping Maintenance Default screens when you enter new contracts and customers. These defaults are also maintained within Advanced Shipping. Other key Advanced Shipping master files are:

- Name and address. These define the EDI trading partner details for sending Advanced Shipping Notifications (ASNs) to be sent by EDI.
- Calendar files. These define calendars which may be attached to the shipping company stockrooms and the customer contract.
- Despatch profiles. These define a sequenced list of stockrooms for multi-sourcing of Advanced Customer Scheduling contracts.
- Pack and pallet information. These define the parameters of a particular pack type; a particular pallet type and the relationship of a customer / item with a specific pack and pallet.

Build and Maintain Consignments

This function allows you to create or maintain consignments on which to ship to a specified customer on a specified day. It is the main area of the Advanced Shipping processing function.

The Build Screen

This screen displays an item or RAN per screen, and the screen is divided into three distinct areas:

- The top section of the screen shows the required quantity to be shipped to the customer on or before the specified date. This is driven from the reconciled requirements file which is updated by the Advanced Customer Scheduling acceptance sleeper.
- This section of the screen also shows quantities which have already been reserved or built on to a consignment for the requirement, and what outstanding action quantities there are. It also highlights, in red, if there is not enough stock available to satisfy the requirement.
- The second portion of the 'build' screen covers sourcing the requirement. It lists either the single stockroom or despatch profile stockrooms associated with the relevant contract. It displays how much stock has been used for this requirement and how much is still available.
 - 'Allocated unbuilt', stock has been reserved but not yet built on to a consignment;
 - 'Allocated and built' has been allocated from the stockroom(s) and built on to consignment(s)
- Normally supply companies will not reserve stock without building it on to a consignment simultaneously, but this facility would be used to reserve stock against a RAN until sufficient stock is available to build a whole RAN onto a consignment.
- The third section of the 'build' screen lists consignments for the specified customer on the specified date. It will display any stock for the requirement being viewed which has already been built on the consignment(s).
- Default action quantities are suggested on this screen; sourcing is suggested against the available stock in priority sequence until either the requirement is satisfied or no stock remains. Suggested stock allocations are in pack rounded quantities where appropriate. Action quantities can be forced through which will make available stock negative (this is assuming the stockroom has been set up in Inventory Management to accept negative stock).

Confirm Despatches and Consignments

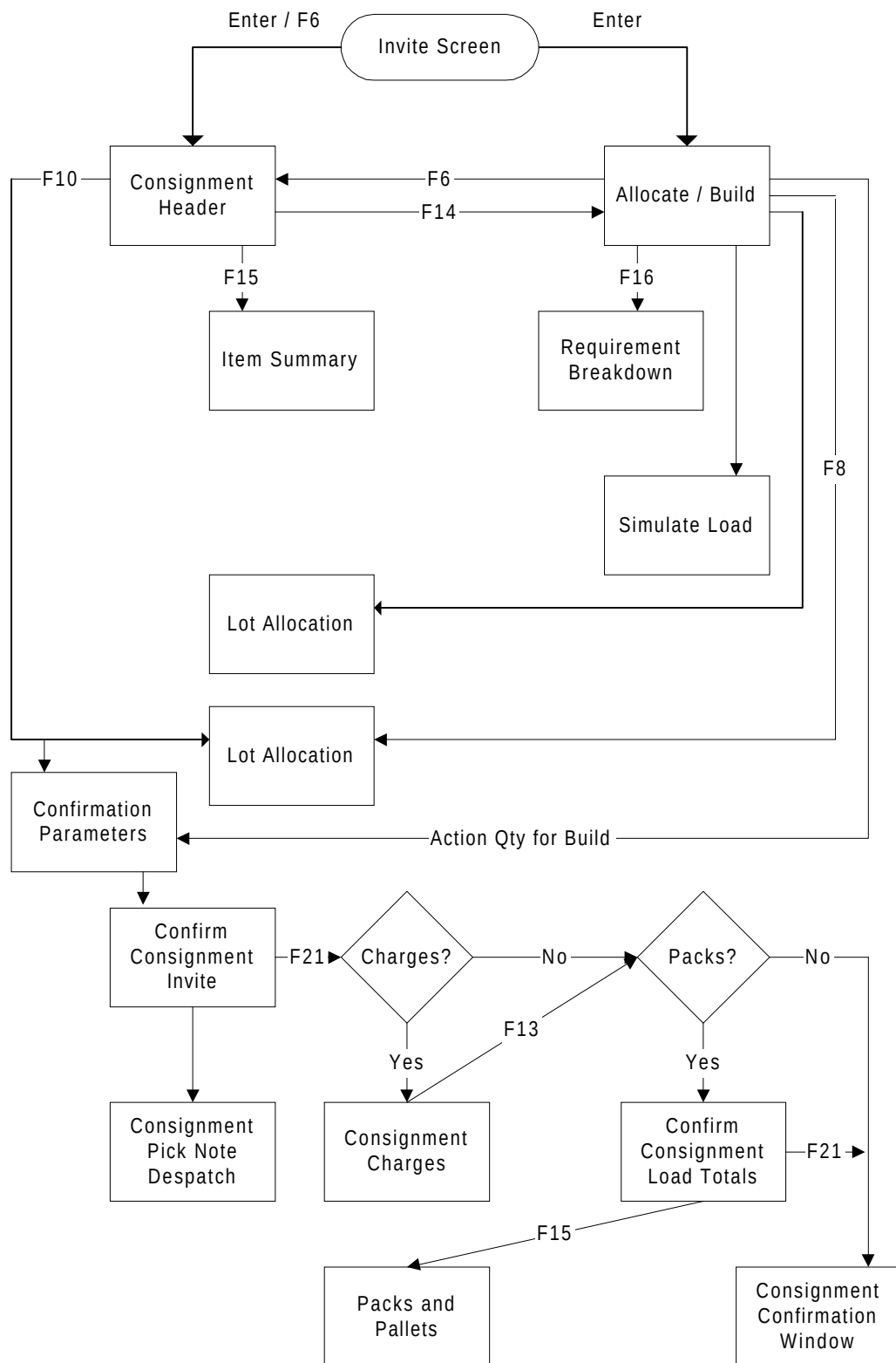
When you have built everything you want on a particular consignment, you can, as required, print picking documentation. You can then confirm despatch against the consignment. This function can be accessed through the same build function, or via a separate menu option: Consignment Confirm Despatch.

In despatch confirmation, the invite screen summarises the despatches on a consignment by stockroom and allows you to fully confirm all despatches for one or more stockrooms with a function key. Alternatively you can override despatch quantities by stockroom.

Once despatches have been confirmed, you can confirm the total consignment, and charges may be added at consignment level. Where pack and pallet information is required, this will be generated when you first confirm the consignment. Totals will be displayed and overrides are allowed.

You can drill down to review and, if necessary, maintain pack and pallet information or simply accept the calculated values. Final consignment confirmation creates the records necessary for producing Advanced Shipping Notes (ASNs).

Consignment Processing



Consignment Invoices

Shipments may be invoiced either according to normal consolidation rules (daily, weekly, monthly) or at one of the lower level Advanced Shipping consolidation levels:

- One invoice per consignment.
- One invoice per consignment / contract.
- One invoice per consignment / contract / RAN.

Consignment Notes

Confirm Consignment produces a consignment note which summarises despatches for the consignment regardless of the stockroom. (Pick notes, if required, will be produced for each stockroom).

The consignment note will give brief pack and pallet details where appropriate.

Consignment Stocks and Self Billing

Consignment Stocks

Consignment stock processing is used when a supplier transfers goods to a holding area, generally known as a consignment warehouse, instead of directly to a customer. The goods remain the property of the supplier and are referred to as consignment stock. At the Advanced Shipping confirmation stage no updates are made to inventory, invoice records are not created and the shipment is a transfer order and not a sales order.

The customer has direct access to goods in the consignment stockroom and takes them as they are required. The customer then notifies the supplier that they have consumed these goods and upon receipt of this notification inventory is updated and an invoice is raised.

Self Billing

Self billing allows the customer to reduce the cost of matching invoices against consignment notes by calculating the invoice they are expecting from the supplier. The customer notifies the supplier of the invoice details that it has raised against itself.

Consignment stock processing and self billing are often performed together as the customer notification of stock consumption can be used to match a self billed invoice.

Fastpath Shipping And Confirmation

Fastpath shipping allows you an alternative way of creating and confirming a consignment. The consignment build and confirmation processes provide a comprehensive system but if you do not require a wide choice of options then Fastpath shipping offers you a limited but more simplified process.

The Fastpath shipping option allows you to create and confirm a consignment in one step. The Fastpath confirmation option allows you to amend details and confirm existing Fastpath consignments.

When a consignment has been confirmed, inventory values are updated and invoice records are created.

However, before using the Fastpath shipping option, please note that:

- Fastpath shipping uses the single stockroom or first stockroom entered in the Despatch Profile option from the Contract Defaults screen, and not multiple stockrooms.
- Fastpath shipping uses a simple separate packaging mechanism and not multilevel packaging.
- Consignments created using Fastpath shipping are not suitable for use with the ASN options. It is recommended that the send ASN field in the customer defaults maintenance screen is set to no.
- Fastpath shipping does not integrate with the Warehousing module.

Pack and Pallet Details

- A pallet is an outer container; it may be a large crate which packs sit in, or a traditional pallet which packs sit on top of.
- A pack is the inner container an item is shipped in and the normal pack quantity is used in pack rounding.

The system uses some basic rules to produce pack and pallet details for the goods on a consignment. The system creates details for each combination of:

- Item
- Consignment
- Contract
- Stockroom
- RAN

The system assumes different lot numbers can be mixed on a pallet, but not in a pack, and that different RAN's cannot be mixed on a pallet, or in a pack. You can later manipulate the pack and pallet details.

Specifications can be made for pack quantities, number of packs per pallet layer, a minimum number of layers and a maximum number of layers, whether complete pallet layers must be shipped, and whether odd packs can be shipped.

The system can generate dummy packs (empty boxes) to fulfil the complete layers flag. There may even be complete dummy layers up to the minimum number of layers.

Pack, pallet and item weights and volumes are accumulated to calculate consignment totals, which you can amend before you confirm the despatch.

Shipping RAN Requirements

Advanced Shipping recognises Advanced Customer Schedule RAN requirements and applies different validation rules. They are displayed individually on the build screen where other requirements are summarised by item. They may be split or part sourced but they cannot be part built. The system will only allow a RAN to be built on to a single consignment, in its entirety. In addition, a warning message is presented when you put multiple RANs on the same consignment.

Load Simulation Facility

During the build process you can assess the impact of building a particular action quantity on to a consignment by using the simulate load function.

This facility runs through the packs and pallets routine normally performed by Consignment Confirm Despatch and summarises the weights, volumes, and numbers of pallets required by what is already built onto the consignment.

The system then simulates the pack and pallet requirements for the current action quantity and shows the resulting totals for the consignment. The action quantity may be manipulated and the results recalculated.

ASN and ANSI X12 856 Maintenance and Send

ASNs are electronically transmitted messages (usually via EDI) which provide advance information about the configuration of shipments or consignments. Normally an ASN will contain hierarchical information relating to the shipment itself; the orders or schedules on the shipment; the items contained in the shipment; and how those items are packaged.

Typically the ASN is transmitted to the delivery customer but in certain circumstances may be transmitted to other parties with an interest in the shipment, such as the carrier.

Original equipment manufacturers (OEMs) are increasingly placing a requirement upon their suppliers to transmit ASNs to them, often within a specified time span of the shipment actually leaving the suppliers plant. This time span is as small as fifteen minutes for some OEMs.

Many manufacturers wish to use the information contained in the ASN to streamline their goods receiving processes. The ASN information may include details of bar-coded packaging labels. Upon receipt, the bar-coded labels are read via hand held scanners and the goods contained within are automatically checked in to stock against expected receipts information provided by the ASN.

The screens relating to item details and their associated packaging details are optional. You can choose how deep into the maintenance options you wish to go by either accepting the packaging information already generated (or not if pack details are not required), or delving deeper and maintaining the packaging details manually.

The ANSI X12 856 ASNs is of increasing importance if you trade in, or with clients in, North America. It behaves in a similar way to a European ASN but differs in its use of the hierarchical levels and does not have a fixed structure. It therefore allows more specific data to be included. Hierarchical levels can be set up for each shipment in any sequence and levels can be omitted. The sequence is agreed between the customer and the supplier.

The ANSI X12 856 ASN is only available if your system has been specifically set up to use this facility.

Record Locking Considerations

- Company and calendar maintenance require exclusive use of the system.
- The following simultaneous updates are prohibited via record locking:
 - Maintaining contract shipping details whilst processing them in Build & Maintain Consignments.
 - Maintaining a customer whilst processing one of their contracts in shipping processing.
 - Maintaining despatch profile / pack /pallet / item whilst processing with them in shipping processing.



Note: The Advanced Shipping company, customer, and contract maintenance options will automatically be linked to the corresponding Advanced Customer Scheduling options if this is available, to prevent users having to enter details from two separate menu options when initially creating new customer and contract processing defaults.